

Chapter 155-5

Liang Shi watched from the side, frowning. "Are you like this whenever you start filming?"

Gu Yixue nodded: "Mm, too tired. Don't really feel like eating."

Liang Shi: "..."

"You've lost a lot more weight compared to when we first started filming." Liang Shi said: "Really, you can't get any thinner."

Hearing this, Gu Yixue smiled. "What? Is losing weight rapidly against the law?"

"Well, not exactly." Liang Shi said: "Being too thin or too fat both make you prone to illness."

"With this body of mine, the sooner I die, the sooner it's over." Gu Yixue didn't seem offended. She spoke about life and death in a casual, carefree manner. This reminded Liang Shi of Chen Mian, and she suddenly asked: "Are all genius artists like you very..."

Liang Shi paused, racking her brain for the right adjective. In the end, all she could think of was: "Crazy?"

Gu Yixue: "Hm?"

"Don't compare me to Qin Lishuang." Gu Yixue thought she was talking about Qin Lishuang and immediately distanced herself: "We're not the same kind of person."

Liang Shi shook her head: "Not Qin Lishuang. It's... Chen Mian. Do you know her? She's also a painter, a very talented artist. She's a little bit like you."

Gu Yixue paused briefly. "I've seen her paintings."

"But you know her?" Gu Yixue smiled. "I was just worrying about how to contact her. Are you two close?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Fairly close, I guess?" Liang Shi said: "At least I have her contact information."

"I want to ask her to paint something for the opening and ending scenes of the film. It would also be used as a backdrop in the movie." Gu Yixue said: "Help me ask if she's willing to paint it. The price is negotiable."

Liang Shi: "..."

Gu Yixue didn't push her. She just said: "If it puts you in a difficult position, I'll find her myself. I have some friends in the industry. It's just that I heard she doesn't like being in the spotlight and only paints when she feels like it."

Liang Shi: "It's fine, I'll ask her."

Speaking of Chen Mian, Gu Yixue suddenly said: "Why do people say artists shouldn't be too rich? Back then, Chen Mian's breakthrough piece sold for twenty million, and from then on she became willful. She doesn't care at all how much money people offer for her paintings—everything depends on whether she likes them at first sight."

"That's true." Liang Shi said: "She is quite willful, but she's also quite easy to talk to."

At least for Liang Shi, that was the case.

Liang Shi messaged Chen Mian with the specific requirements but didn't mention she was filming with Gu Yixue. She only said "our director," and Chen Mian asked who the director was.

Liang Shi replied: [Gu Yixue.]

Then Chen Mian video-called her.

Liang Shi was shocked and immediately answered.

Gu Yixue casually leaned over and waved. "Hello."

Chen Mian glanced at the camera and got straight to the point: "What do you want me to paint?"

Gu Yixue asked tentatively: "Meet up to discuss? I'll treat you to drinks."

Chen Mian thought for a moment. "Okay, tonight?"

Gu Yixue: "Sure."

In less than a minute, a major matter was settled.

Then, with Chen Mian's consent, Liang Shi shared Chen Mian's contact information with Gu Yixue.

Their work efficiency left Liang Shi dumbfounded.

Gu Yixue was amused by her expression. "What? Never seen such a fast collaboration?"

Liang Shi nodded: "It's just... do geniuses communicate through brain waves?"

Gu Yixue: "..."

"Little sister, how are you so cute?" Gu Yixue genuinely laughed, her brows and eyes tinged with relaxation. It had been many days since anyone had seen such an expression on her. Liang Shi was also infected by this ease.

Liang Shi said sincerely: "I thought you would at least discuss each other's compensation, style, and such. I didn't expect you could just directly arrange to have drinks."

"Whether someone is suitable for collaboration—you can tell at a glance." Gu Yixue also answered her sincerely: "I've seen her paintings, she's seen my films, so we hit it off immediately."

"Looks like even without me, you two could have made it work." Liang Shi said: "I was just a connecting thread."

"No, you're also very important." Gu Yixue said: "This thread of yours saved us a lot of trouble. I'll give you a 1% cut when the time comes."

"Then how much can you offer Chen Mian?"

Gu Yixue paused: "Depends on what she wants. She might just ask me to treat her to drinks."

Liang Shi: "..."

So feelings were all lies.

The two of them ate and chatted casually. Just when they were having a good time, a cold and overbearing voice came through: "Where's Gu Yixue? She's letting you eat this kind of stuff? Where is she?"

Just as the voice fell, Gu Yixue's phone started ringing.

Gu Yixue looked at the food she had only taken a few bites of—she hadn't even finished the portion piled on top.

Liang Shi quickly shoveled a few more bites of rice, then stood up to follow. She casually asked: "Who is it?"

"Trash attracted another piece of trash." Gu Yixue said as she dismissed the call, and the ringing finally stopped. Then she walked over in that direction.

That person had a baby face and wasn't very tall. She stood next to the woman in the qipao who had come that morning, saying with a face full of distress: "This isn't fit for human consumption. Why are you eating this? Gu Yixue must have done this on purpose."

The moment Gu Yixue was mentioned, she became filled with righteous indignation.

"Would I bother?" Gu Yixue hadn't even walked over yet when she heard this and spoke coldly.

"Gu Yixue." The baby-faced woman glared viciously at Gu Yixue: "I told you to take good care of Wenwen. Is this how you treat her? If you have a problem with me, come at me directly. Don't secretly trip me up. I look down on this kind of behavior the most."

"Everyone eats the same thing." Gu Yixue said: "She wanted to act in my production, so she has to follow my rules. There are so many people here, and I eat the same food. How is it not fit for human consumption? Everyone else can eat it, but only your Wenwen can't? Then take her away. What's the point of this?"

"Stop acting like a saint after being a whore." Gu Yixue scoffed, her eyes ice-cold. "If you want to cause trouble on my set..."

"What are you going to do?" Before she could finish, the baby-faced woman interrupted and mocked: "Gu Yixue, have you gotten too bold? Don't think that just because you've grown up, you're no longer surnamed Gu."

"So what?" Gu Yixue asked calmly in return.

This actually stumped the baby-faced woman.

Everyone present fell silent, not daring to breathe loudly.

It seemed like everyone was waiting for the drama to unfold.

Then Gu Yixue concluded: "If she can act, she acts. If she can't, take her back early. You've been keeping her for so long anyway; you won't mind a few more years."

Before her words even finished, the baby-faced woman's fist swung toward her, but Gu Yixue grabbed it tightly, rendering it immobile.

Gu Yixue looked at her lazily and said coldly: "Gu Chunmian, do you still think I'm the Gu Yixue from twenty years ago?"

Although Gu Yixue was thin, she was also quite strong.

Sun Chengcheng, standing to the side, immediately recalled Gu Yixue's profile introduction upon hearing this name.

The person she hated the most—Gu Chunmian.

But the current situation didn't allow her to do anything; she could only stay quiet.

Footnotes:

1. "Acting like a saint after being a whore" (當了婊子又立牌坊): A crude Chinese idiom meaning to act virtuously or self-righteously while having done something shameful or hypocritical. It describes someone who pretends to be innocent or moral despite their questionable actions.